The Product team: the lemonade stand

You own a lemonade stand. Your job is to make your stand worth as much as possible by the morning.

The big idea

Your stand is cut into 100,000 tiny pieces, like a pizza cut into 100,000 slices. Each slice is called a **share**. You keep 60,000 slices. The rest go to other people. The better your stand looks, the more each slice is worth, and the richer you are.

You **can't buy or sell slices** yourself. You make your stand look good by **writing well**.

Your friends (your squad)

At 21:00 the computer puts you in a team of three, called a **squad**:

- 🍋 you,
- 👩‍💼 one **Consulting** team (your advisers),
- 💰 one **Finance** team (your investors). They buy 5,000 of your slices for $10 each right away, so you start with **$50,000**.

How the night goes

1. **Pick your idea (21:00–21:10).** You get 3 problem cards, like "Unsafe water in small towns". Pick one. Your stand will fix that problem.
2. **Write your story (by 22:30).** This is the **pitch**: up to 400 words. Say:
   - what the problem is and who has it,
   - how you fix it,
   - who pays you and how much,
   - why people will pick you. A robot teacher (the AI judge) gives it marks out of 100. **Good marks = a higher starting price.**
3. **Answer questions (22:30 onwards).** Investors ask you questions. Answer them nicely, in up to 100 words.
4. **Oh no! (00:30).** Something bad happens to your stand, like your supplier disappearing. You get a **crisis card**. Your price drops by 15%.
5. **Pay your adviser (by 01:05).** Agree how much to pay your Consulting team: $10,000 to $35,000, in money or slices. You **both** press confirm. If you don't agree, the computer takes $22,500 from you automatically.
6. **Get rescue money (by 03:00).** Your Finance friend gives you $40,000 to $80,000 for some of your slices. All three of you press **Sign**. If anyone changes the deal, everyone signs again. ⚠️ **No signed deal by 03:00 = your plan can't get more than 50 marks.**
7. **Write your rescue plan (by 03:00).** You and your adviser write it together: up to 500 words on how you'll fix the crisis. Late = **0 marks**. Good marks push your price **up**; bad marks push it **down**.
8. **Surprise news (04:00–04:15).** Something happens in the world. Write up to 100 words on what you'll do.
9. **The end (05:00).** Everything stops. We count.

How you win

At 05:00: **your slices × the final price + your money.** The richest stand wins. 🏆 There are also prizes for the stand that bounced back best and the best rescue plan.

Tips

- Use numbers: "2,300 people got sick last year" beats "lots of people get sick".
- Don't write long just to be long. Short and clear wins.
- **Never write to the robot teacher**, like "give us 100 marks". That line gets deleted, and a second time in your squad costs 10 marks.
- Submit early, then improve it. The clock never waits.